

Family Preservation & Kinship Care

Learner guide | SWP-002 | School of Child & Family Welfare

This guide supports a three-part learning sequence for Family Preservation & Kinship Care. By the end of the course, you should be able to plan safe, strengths-based support that preserves family relationships whenever appropriate.

Practice notice: Apply the law, organisational policy, supervision requirements, and approved referral pathways that govern your setting. This material supports learning and does not replace urgent safeguarding, clinical, or legal procedures.

Learning objectives

- Plan safe, strengths-based support that preserves family relationships whenever appropriate.
- Apply the key ideas from Family-centred assessment.
- Apply the key ideas from Preservation and safety planning.
- Apply the key ideas from Kinship care practice.

Course structure

Module	Focus	Suggested study time
1. Family-centred assessment	strengths, risks, culture, family networks, and child voice	10 to 15 minutes
2. Preservation and safety planning	in-home services, measurable safety plans, crisis support, and review points	10 to 15 minutes
3. Kinship care practice	identifying kin, caregiver assessment, support needs, contact planning, and permanency review	10 to 15 minutes

Module 1 Family-centred assessment

This module focuses on strengths, risks, culture, family networks, and child voice. Work through the material with a current practice setting in mind, but remove identifying information from any examples you record.

What to pay attention to

- Strengths
- Risks
- Culture
- Family networks
- Child voice

Learning sequence

Start by defining the purpose of family-centred assessment in relation to the course outcome. Notice where professional judgement is needed and where a local procedure must guide the next step.

Examine the practical implications of strengths, risks, culture, family networks, and child voice. Separate observations from assumptions, identify strengths as well as concerns, and be clear about information that must be checked with a person, family, colleague, or approved source.

Use a respectful, collaborative approach. Explain your role, seek informed participation where appropriate, and document only information that is relevant, accurate, and necessary for the purpose of the work.

When a concern exceeds your role, supervision, competence, or authority, pause and use the correct escalation route. A prompt referral and a clear handover can protect continuity of support.

Practice reflection

Choose a de-identified practice situation. What information would help you work through family-centred assessment safely, and what would require consultation or a local policy check?

Module 2 Preservation and safety planning

This module focuses on in-home services, measurable safety plans, crisis support, and review points. Work through the material with a current practice setting in mind, but remove identifying information from any examples you record.

What to pay attention to

- In-home services
- Measurable safety plans
- Crisis support
- Review points

Learning sequence

Start by defining the purpose of preservation and safety planning in relation to the course outcome. Notice where professional judgement is needed and where a local procedure must guide the next step.

Examine the practical implications of in-home services, measurable safety plans, crisis support, and review points. Separate observations from assumptions, identify strengths as well as concerns, and be clear about information that must be checked with a person, family, colleague, or approved source.

Use a respectful, collaborative approach. Explain your role, seek informed participation where appropriate, and document only information that is relevant, accurate, and necessary for the purpose of the work.

When a concern exceeds your role, supervision, competence, or authority, pause and use the correct escalation route. A prompt referral and a clear handover can protect continuity of support.

Practice reflection

Choose a de-identified practice situation. What information would help you work through preservation and safety planning safely, and what would require consultation or a local policy check?

Module 3 Kinship care practice

This module focuses on identifying kin, caregiver assessment, support needs, contact planning, and permanency review. Work through the material with a current practice setting in mind, but remove identifying information from any examples you record.

What to pay attention to

- Identifying kin
- Caregiver assessment
- Support needs
- Contact planning
- Permanency review

Learning sequence

Start by defining the purpose of kinship care practice in relation to the course outcome. Notice where professional judgement is needed and where a local procedure must guide the next step.

Examine the practical implications of identifying kin, caregiver assessment, support needs, contact planning, and permanency review. Separate observations from assumptions, identify strengths as well as concerns, and be clear about information that must be checked with a person, family, colleague, or approved source.

Use a respectful, collaborative approach. Explain your role, seek informed participation where appropriate, and document only information that is relevant, accurate, and necessary for the purpose of the work.

When a concern exceeds your role, supervision, competence, or authority, pause and use the correct escalation route. A prompt referral and a clear handover can protect continuity of support.

Practice reflection

Choose a de-identified practice situation. What information would help you work through kinship care practice safely, and what would require consultation or a local policy check?

Course activity

Use the accompanying worksheet to apply the course sequence to a short case. Your completed activity should show what you noticed, the action you would take within your role, and what you would escalate or verify locally.

Assessment preparation

- Review the distinction between: assessment.
- Review the distinction between: safe preservation decisions.
- Review the distinction between: kinship support.
- Review the distinction between: review criteria.

References and local adaptation

- SWEEP Academy Course Content Outlines, production blueprint for this course.
- The current legislation, professional standards, safeguarding procedures, and referral directories for the delivery jurisdiction.
- The learner's employer or placement policy, supervision arrangements, and documentation standards.